

Activity 12 - Accept, Handover and Close the Project

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 7 | Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments Learning outcome: LO7 Duration: 35 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Acceptance, Handover, Closure and Benefits Tracker plus Retrospective

Objective

Close only when deliverables, transition, contracts, records and benefits ownership are evidenced (A7).

The situation

All three outlets are live, but final payment is requested before complete acceptance evidence, support ownership, training records and unresolved-item decisions are consolidated. Benefits will continue after project closure.

What you will do

Validate acceptance, transfer operations and knowledge, resolve contracts and open items, capture lessons and assign post-project benefits measures before recommending closure.

What you will produce

Signed acceptance matrix, handover and training evidence, unresolved-item disposition, contract closeout, lessons register, benefits tracker and formal closure recommendation.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/44 Agile Retrospective.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/12 Acceptance Handover Closure and Benefits.xlsx`](#)

Data files

- [`data/closure-input.csv`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Trace each accepted deliverable to its requirement, criterion, evidence and authorised approver.
2. List operational ownership, support levels, data ownership, monitoring and escalation after handover.
3. Verify training completion, knowledge transfer and access to current operating documentation.
4. Resolve or formally transfer every open issue, defect, risk, change and supplier obligation.
5. Confirm final invoices, warranties, contract records and payment approval conditions.
6. Run the retrospective and convert lessons into reusable recommendations with owners.
7. Assign benefits owners, measures, baselines, targets and review dates after closure.
8. Recommend close, close with transferred actions, or remain open; record sponsor approval.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

Acceptance is traceable, handover ownership is explicit, open items have formal disposition, contracts and records reconcile, and benefits continue under named operational owners.

Debrief

- Elapsed time does not close a project; complete evidence and transferred accountability do.
- Lessons become assets only when future owners can find and use them.
- Project work ends before benefits measurement ends.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 12. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.